PROJECT 10073 RECORD

4

1. DATE - TIME GROUP 2 - 3 September 1965	2. LOCATION Exeter, New Hampshire
3. SOURCE Civilians (MULTIPLE)	10. CONCLUSION UNIDENTIFIED
4. NUMBER OF OBJECTS Multiple	
5. LENGTH OF OBSERVATION 2 Hour Period	11. BRIEF SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS SEE CASE FILE There were aircraft in the area of the sighting between 03/0044Z and 03/0535Z on OPERATION "BIG BLAST".
6. TYPE OF OBSERVATION Ground-Visual	
7. COURSE Varied, Stationary	
8. PHOTOS ( ) Yes XX No	
9. PHYSICAL EVIDENCE ( ) Yes XX No	

FORM
FTD [illegible] 0-329 (TDE) Previous editions of this form are obsolete

HEADQUARTERS
817th COMBAT SUPPORT GROUP (SAC)
UNITED STATES AIR FORCE
Pease Air Force Base, New Hampshire 03803

REPLY TO ATTN OF: BDC

SUBJECT: Initial Report of Unidentified Flying Object (UFO)

15 SEP 1965

TO: AFCS (FTD)

The following report of an unidentified flying object is hereby submitted in accordance with AFR 200-2.

a. Description of object.

(1) Round.

(2) Baseball.

(3) Bright red.

(4) Five red lights in a row.

(5) Lights were close together and moved as one object.

(6) None

(7) None

(8) None

(9) Extremely bright red.

b. Description of course of object.

(1) Visual sighting.

(2) Object was at an altitude of approximately 100 ft and moved in an arc of 135 degrees.

(3) Object disappeared at an altitude of approximately 100 ft on a mag. heading of approximately 160 degrees.

(2) Civilian. Eugene F Bertrand Jr. Age, 30. Exeter Police Department, Exeter N.H. Patrolman. Reliable.

(3) Civilian. David R Hunt. Age, 28. Exeter Police Department, Exeter N.H. Patrolman. Reliable.

g. Weather and Winds.

(1) The weather was clear with no known weather phenomenon. There was a 5 degree inversion from surface to 5000 ft.

(2) Winds at Pease AFB, N.H.

ALTITUDE	WINDS
Surface	290/03
6000	310/03
10000	270/77
16000	270/56
30000	260/49
50000	250/33
80000	Not Rec.

(3) Clear (unlimited).

(4) 30 N.M.

(5) None.

(6) None.

(7) See SKEW T. Log P diagram.

h. None

i. None

j. None

(4) The object was erratic in movement and would disappear behind trees and houses in the area. It would then appear at a position other than where it disappeared. When in view it would act as a floating leaf.

(5) Object departed on a heading of 160 degrees and was observed until it disappeared in the distance.

(6) One hour.

c. Manner of Observation.

(1) Ground - visual.

(2) None.

(3) N/A.

d. Time and date of sighting.

(1) 03/09/0600Z

(2) Night

e. Location of observer.

(1) 3 N.M. South West of Exeter, N.H.

f. Identifying information on observer.

(1) Civilian. [redacted]. Age, 18. [redacted] Exeter N.H. Unemployed (will join Navy on 18 Sept 65). Appears to be reliable.

k. Major David H. Griffin, Base Disaster Control Officer, Command Pilot.

(1) At this time have been unable to arrive at a probable cause of this sighting. The three observers seem to be stable reliable persons, especially the two patrolman. I viewed the area of the sighting and found nothing in the area that could be the probable cause. Pease AFB had 5 B-47 aircraft flying in the area during this period but do not believe they had any connection with this sighting.

1. None.

FOR THE COMMANDER

[redacted]

4 Atch
1. Statement, UFO Sighting, Eugene F. Bertrand Jr.
2. Statement, UFO Sighting, David R. Hunt.
3. Statement, UFO Sighting, [redacted]
4. SKEW T, Log P Diagram

S T A T E M E N T

UFO Sighting

I, Eugene F. Bertrand Jr., was cruising on the morning of the 3rd of September at 0100 on Rte. 108 by-pass near Exeter N.H. I noticed an automobile parked on the side of the road and stopped to investigate. I found a woman in the car who stated she was to upset to drive. She stated a light had been following her and had stopped over her car. I stayed with her about 15 minutes but was unable to see anything. I departed and reported back to the Exeter Police Station where I found [redacted]. He related his story of seeing some bright red lights in a field. After talking with him awhile I decided to take him back to where he said he had seen the lights. When we arrived I parked the patrol cruiser and turned off the lights. There was nothing unusual in the area. Mr[redacted] and I got out of the cruiser and started walking into the field with a flashlight. When we had gone about 50 ft a group of five bright red lights came from behind a group of trees near us. They were extremely bright and flashed on one at a time. The lights started to move around over the field. At one time they came so close I fell to the ground and started to draw my gun. The lights were so bright Iwas unable to make out any form. There was no sound or vibration but the farm animals were upset in the area and making a lot of noise. When the lights started coming near us again, Mr.[redacted] and I ran for the car. I radioed Patrolman David Hunt who arrived in a few minutes. He also observed the lights which were still over the field but not as close as before. The lights moved out across the field at an estimated altitude of 100 ft and finally disappeared in the distance at the same altitude. The lights were always in line at about 60 degree angle. When the object moved the lower lights were always forward of the others.

EUGENE F. BERTRAND JR
Patrolman

S T A T E M E N T

UFO Sighting

I, David R. Hunt, at about 0255 on the morning of the 3rd of September, received a call from Patrolman Bertrand to report to an area about 3 miles South West of Exeter, N.H. Upon arriving at the scene I observed a group of bright red lights flashing in sequence. They appeared to be about ½ mile over a field to the South East. After observing the lights for a short period of time, they moved off in a South Easterly direction and disappeared in the distance. The lights appeared to remain at the same altitude which I estimate to be about 100 ft.

DAVID R. HUNT
Patrolman

S T A T E M E N T

UFO Sighting

I, [redacted] was hitchhicking on Rte. 150, 3 miles South West of Exeter N.H. at 0200 hours on the 3rd of September. A group of five bright red lights appeared over a house about 100 ft from where I was standing. The lights were in a line at about 60 degree angle. They were so bright they lighted up the area. The lights then moved out over a large field and acted at times like a floating leaf. They would go down behind the trees or behind a house and then re-appear. They always moved in the same 60 degree angle. Only one light would be on at a time. They were pulsating 1,2,3,4,5,5,4,3,2,1. They were so bright I could not distinguish any form to the object. I watched these lights for about 15 minutes and they finally disappeared behind some trees and seemed to go into a field. At one time while I was watching them, they seemed to come so close I jumped into a ditch to keep from being hit. After the lights went into the field I caught a ride to the Exeter Police Station and reported what I had seen.

[redacted]

December 2, 1965

Hector Quintanilla, Jr., Major, USAF
Chief, Project Blue Book
Wright Patterson AFB
Dayton, Ohio

Dear Sir:

We were very glad to get your letter during the third week in November, because as you might imagine we have been the subject of considerable ridicule since the Pentagon released its "final evaluation" of our sighting of September 3, 1965. In other words, both Ptl. Hunt and myself saw this object af close range, checked it out with each other, confirmed and reconfirmed the fact that this was not any kind of conventional aircraft, that it was at an altitude of not more than a couple of hundred feet, and went to considerable trouble to [redacted] confirm that the weather was clear, there was no wind, no chance of weather inversion, and that what we were seeing was no illusion or military or civilian craft. We entered this in a complete official police report as a supplement to the blotter of the morning of September 3 (not September 2, as you letter indicates). Since our job [redacted] depends on accuracy and an ability to tell the difference between fact and fiction, we were naturally disturbed by the Pentagon report which attributed the sighting to "multiple high altitude objects" in the area and "weather inversion." What is a little difficult to understand is the fact that your letter (undated) arrived considerably after the Pentagon release, [redacted] Since your letter says that you are still in the process of making a final evaluation, it seems that there is an inconsistency here. Ordinarily, this wouldn't be too important except for the fact that in a situation like this we are naturally very reluctant to be considered irresponsible in our official report to the police station.

Since one of us (Ptl. Bertrand) was in the Air Force for four years engaged in refueling operations with all kinds of military aircraft, it was impossible to mistake what we saw for any time of military operation, regardless of altitude. It was also definitely not a helicopter or balloon. Immediately after the object disappeared, we did see what probably was a B-47 at high altitude, but it bore no relation at all to the object we saw.

Another fact is that the time of our observation was nearly an hour after 2:00 AM, which would eliminate the 8th Air Force operation Big Blast, since as you say this took place between midnight and 2:00 AM. [redacted], who first reported this object before we went to the sight saw it somewhere in the vicinity of 2 AM, but nearly an hour had passed before he got into the police station, and we went out to the location with him.

2 of 2

15 Sep 65.

February 9, 1966

Mrs Hunt/sh/SAFOICC/72842/9 Feb 66

Gentlemen:

Based on the additional information you submitted to our UFO investigation office at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio, we have been unable to identify the object you observed on September 3, 1965.

I am inclosing a copy of a letter to Mr[redacted] of Wenham, Massachusetts. I hope this will help to clarify our initial statement regarding the sightings in Exeter.

In 19 years of investigating over 10,000 reports of unidentified flying objects, the evidence has proved almost conclusively that reported aerial phenomena have been objects either created and sent aloft by man, generated by atmospheric conditions, or caused by celestial bodies or the residue of meteoric activity.

Thank you for reporting your observation to the Air Force and for your subsequent cooperation regarding the report. I regret any inconvenience you may have suffered as a result.

Sincerely,

1 Atch
Letter

JOHN P. SPAULDING
Lt Colonel, USAF
Chief, Civil Branch
Community Relations Division
Office of Information

Mr. [redacted]
Mr. [redacted]

COORDINATED By (Office Symbol, Name, Grade, Date)			
SAF-OI	SAF-OI		

~~Coord cy~~ - SAF-OIC
Combk cy - SAF-OIC
Reader cy - SAF-OIC
[illegible] - SAF-OIC

TDEW/UFO

MAR 3 1966

UFO Information, Exeter, New Hampshire

RADC (EMYS)
Attn: Major Burnside

1. Reference your request for information on the Exeter, New Hampshire unidentified flying object report. A summary of the incident is as follows:

a. The sighting was made on the morning of 3 September 1965. Initial investigation was made by officers from Pease AFB, New Hampshire following wide spread publicity in the local newspapers from the New Hampshire area. A copy of the initial report, dated 15 September and two newspaper articles from 6 and 7 September are included in the case file. Information received in the initial report regarding description of the object and newspaper coverage was not sufficient for a firm evaluation of the sighting. The general description of flashing lights is consistent with previous reports of aircraft, refueling operations or low level photographic missions using infra-red lights. On 28 September an investigation attempting to place a specific aircraft of these types over Exeter was made. Results of this investigation indicated that an 8th Air Force operation "Big Blast" was conducted in the New England area and B-47 aircraft from Pease AFB were also involved in the operation. Letters were written to Patrolmen Bertrand and Hunt and to the Hqs 8th Air Force at Westover AFB. A reply from the 8th Air Force indicated that ten B-47 aircraft landed at Pease AFB between 0045 and 0135 local time. The major portion of the sighting occurred subsequent to two a.m. Articles in the Saturday Review of Literature, January 1966 issue and the Look magazine, February 1966 issue, further stimulated public interest in this particular sighting. After consultation with project consultant, Dr. J. Allen Hynek of Northwestern University, a telephone call was made to Lt. Brandt at Pease AFB requesting that the B-47 pilots be interrogated regarding unusual observations and also to determine if infra-red photography was being conducted in the area. A TWX received on 11 February 1966 indicated that no unusual sightings were made by crews during the time period of the unidentified flying object report. His statement regarding night photography is inconclusive. Copies are included in the case.

OFFICIAL FILE COPY
Code of Record

b. Both articles from the Saturday Review and Look Magazine are authored by John C Fuller. The article is essentially factual, however, it is apparent that poetic license and a flair for the sensational has been incorporated into the articles. The only report, submitted to the Air Force for evaluation, is the observation made by the police officers and [redacted]. The other reports, contained in the Look article, have never been reported to the Air Force. Analysis of the report indicates that it is possible for aircraft of a conventional type with rotating beacons or aircraft utilizing infra-red lights in photographic missions to have been the cause of this sighting. Since we have been unable at this time to identify a specific aircraft as the cause of the sighting, the case is regarded for statistical purposes as unidentified. There was no indication that the object presented any evidence whatsoever, of scientific or technical development beyond the present state-of-the-art. There is a total lack of evidence to indicate that the sighting could not have been caused by conventional aircraft.

2. Information on the conduct of the Air Force Project Blue Book was forwarded to your office at an earlier date.

FOR THE COMMANDER

ERIC T. de JONCKHEERE, Colonel, USAF
Deputy for Technology and Subsystems

1 Atch
Case File, Exeter,
New Hampshire

COORDINATION
ORIGINATOR:
TDEW/UFO MAJ H QUINTANILLA, JR H. Quintanilla, Jr DATE 2 Mar 66

for TDEW Neil H. Perkins DATE 2 Mar 66